

F5 Daily Briefing - Thursday, May 07, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

COMPETITORS TRACKED

22

ANNOUNCEMENTS

14

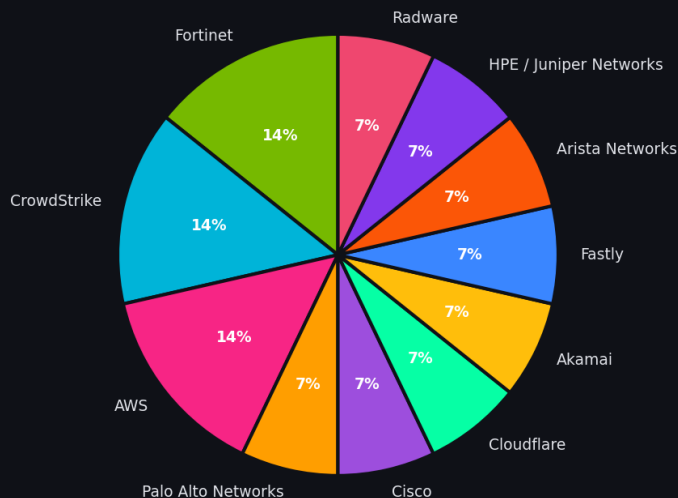
ACTIVE

11

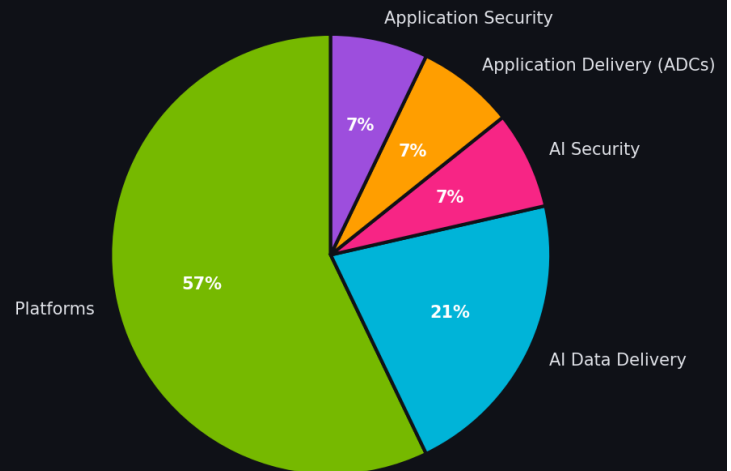
ACTIVE CATEGORIES

5

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (14)

FINANCIAL RESULTS

Radware

2026-05-07

Radware Reports Q1 Revenue Up 11% with Cloud ARR Growing 23% on API Protection and DDoS Strength

Radware reported Q1 2026 revenue of \$79.8M (up 11% YoY) and Cloud ARR of \$98M (up 23% YoY), beating consensus on both top and bottom lines. Non-GAAP EPS came in at \$0.30 vs. \$0.27 expected. Americas revenue surged 40% YoY to \$38.4M while EMEA fell 11% to \$25.1M. Management cited momentum in cloud security – particularly the new API Protection offering – plus on-prem DDoS strength from DefensePro X. SkyHawk results were reclassified as discontinued operations. Radware ended the quarter with \$433.8M in cash and equivalents and \$19.9M operating cash flow.

Source: <https://markets.businessinsider.com/news/stocks/radware-reports-first-quarter-2026-financial-results-1036118885>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-07

Palo Alto Networks Discloses Active Exploitation of PAN-OS Zero-Day RCE (CVE-2026-0300)

Palo Alto Networks confirmed active in-the-wild exploitation of CVE-2026-0300, a critical buffer overflow in the PAN-OS User-ID Authentication Portal that enables unauthenticated remote code execution with root privileges on PA-Series and VM-Series firewalls. Unit 42 attributes the campaign to suspected state-sponsored actor CL-STA-1132, with exploitation dating to April 2026. Prisma Access, Cloud NGFW, and Panorama are unaffected. The vendor urges customers to immediately restrict portal access to trusted internal IPs; first-round patches are expected May 13 with a second wave around May 28. Shadowserver counted over 5,800 exposed instances, predominantly in Asia and North America.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/palo-alto-networks-to-patch-zero-day-exploited-to-hack-firewalls/>

FINANCIAL RESULTS**Fortinet**

2026-05-07

Fortinet Beats Q1 2026 Estimates, Raises Full-Year Outlook on AI-Driven Security Demand

Fortinet reported Q1 2026 revenue of \$1.85B (up 20% YoY) and adjusted EPS of \$0.82 (up 41%), beating consensus by wide margins. Billings grew 31% to \$2.09B – the strongest growth in over three years – driving a sharp after-hours stock rally. Management raised full-year revenue guidance to \$7.71B–\$7.87B and cited firewall refresh cycles, SASE adoption, FortiOS 8.0 with AI security and quantum-safe features, and AI partnerships with Anthropic (Project Glasswing) and OpenAI as growth drivers. Operating cash flow hit a record \$1.08B with \$823M returned via buybacks.

Source: <https://siliconangle.com/2026/05/06/fortinet-shares-surge-first-quarter-earnings-beat-raised-outlook/>

FINANCIAL RESULTS**Fastly**

2026-05-07

Fastly Posts Record Q1 with Security Revenue Up 47%, but Shares Crash 35% on Growth Outlook

Fastly reported Q1 2026 revenue of \$173M (up 20% YoY) and a record 65.1% non-GAAP gross margin, with security revenue surging 47% YoY to 22% of total and compute up 67%. Adjusted EPS of \$0.13 beat consensus of \$0.08. Management raised full-year revenue guidance to \$710–\$725M. Despite the beat, shares plunged ~35% on conservative Q2 EPS guidance (\$0.05–\$0.08) and analyst concerns about decelerating growth. Trailing-twelve-month net retention reached 113%, with 634 large customers and security driven by DDoS, bot management, and API discovery momentum.

Source: <https://www.benzinga.com/trading-ideas/movers/26/05/52368963/fastly-stock-crashes-35-thursday-whats-driving-the-move>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-07

CrowdStrike Launches Jet Partner Mobile App with Real-Time Deal Origination and Cash Rewards

CrowdStrike unveiled Jet, a mobile partner app designed to turn ecosystem engagement into a real-time growth engine. Jet enables partners to register and close deals in under 30 seconds, access enablement resources, track tracking, and receive instant cash-based rewards via CrowdCard with Apple Wallet and Google Wallet integration. The unified app embeds marketplace insights to accelerate pipeline progression. Available by invitation on iOS and Android. The launch reflects CrowdStrike's strategy to deepen partner velocity as AI-driven cybersecurity demand accelerates and competition for channel mindshare intensifies across the security platform market.

Source: <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-advances-ecosystem-engagement-into-a-real-time-growth-engine-with-new-mobile-app/>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-07

CrowdStrike Expands Project QuiltWorks with New Frontier AI Partners

CrowdStrike expanded Project QuiltWorks, its frontier AI cybersecurity initiative, by adding Armadin, Cognizant, and HCLTech as new partners. The program is designed to bolster enterprise protection against rapidly evolving AI-driven cyber threats, including AI-enabled attacks and adversary tradecraft. CrowdStrike also announced its inaugural invite-only Day Zero Threat Research Summit (Aug 30–Sept 1, 2026 in Las Vegas, alongside Fal.Con), featuring researchers from Amazon, Cisco, Google, Microsoft, and Recorded Future. The combined announcements drove CrowdStrike shares higher and reinforced its narrative as a leading AI-native security platform vendor heading into June earnings.

Source: <https://www.benzinga.com/trading-ideas/movers/26/05/52382626/crowdstrike-stock-gains-on-new-ai-cybersecurity-push-partner-app-launch>

FINANCIAL RESULTS**Cloudflare**

2026-05-07

Cloudflare Announces Q1 Beat, 20% Workforce Cut as It Pivots to Agentic AI-First Operating Model

Cloudflare reported Q1 2026 revenue of \$639.8M (up 34% YoY) and non-GAAP EPS of \$0.25, both beating expectations. CEO Matthew Prince simultaneously announced plans to lay off about 1,100 employees – roughly 20% of the workforce – as the company restructures into an 'agentic AI-first' operating model amid a 600% surge in AI usage over the past quarter. Total restructuring charges of \$140–\$150M will hit primarily in Q2. Despite the strong quarter, shares fell ~19% after-hours on the workforce news and modest Q2 guidance, with full-year revenue projected at \$2.805–\$2.813B.

Source: <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/05/07/cloudflare-net-q1-2026-stock-earnings-layoffs.html>

FINANCIAL RESULTS**Arista Networks**

2026-05-07

Arista Networks Q1 Revenue Jumps 35% as XPO Optics and 7800-Powered AI Spine Ship

Arista reported Q1 2026 revenue of \$2.71B, up 35% YoY and beating consensus, with non-GAAP EPS of \$0.87 and operating margin of 47.8%. The company unveiled XPO high-density liquid-cooled pluggable optics – cutting AI rack footprint up to 75% and floor space up to 44% – and a universal AI spine powered by the 7800 with Virtual Output Queuing to scale low-latency AI data center interconnects. NPS held at 89. Q2 revenue is guided to ~\$2.8B with 46–47% margins. Supply constraints are expected to persist for one to two years amid surging AI demand.

Source: <https://siliconangle.com/2026/05/05/aristas-stock-declines-despite-another-solid-earnings-revenue-beat/>

FINANCIAL RESULTS**Akamai**

2026-05-07

Akamai Lands Landmark \$1.8B AI Cloud Deal as CIS Revenue Surges 40%

Akamai unveiled a seven-year, \$1.8 billion cloud infrastructure contract with a leading frontier AI model provider – the largest deal in company history – validating its strategy as a distributed AI inference platform. Q1 2026 total revenue rose 6% to \$1.074B, with Cloud Infrastructure Services up 40% to \$95M and Security up 11% to \$590M. Shares surged 24% after-hours. Akamai raised full-year revenue guidance to \$4.445–\$4.55B and projects double-digit growth in 2027, though margins face pressure from elevated memory prices. The deal positions Akamai as a credible alternative to hyperscalers and neoclouds for AI inference.

Source: https://finance.biggo.com/news/US_AKAM_2026-05-07

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-05-07

AWS Launches Bedrock AgentCore Payments with Coinbase and Stripe for Autonomous AI Agent Transactions

AWS unveiled Bedrock AgentCore Payments, a new payments layer that enables autonomous AI agents to transact in real time. Built on Coinbase's x402 stablecoin protocol and Stripe-owned Privy wallet infrastructure, the service initially supports agent-to-agent micropayments for APIs, data feeds, and paywalled content, with plans to expand to travel, hotels, and merchant payments. Warner Bros. Discovery is an early adopter. The launch positions AWS as foundational infrastructure for the emerging 'agentic economy,' where AI agents act as independent economic actors – a direct platform-level move that pressures rivals offering AI gateways and identity controls.

Source: <https://www.coindesk.com/business/2026/05/07/amazon-rolls-out-ai-agent-stablecoin-payments-platform-with-coinbase-and-stripe>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-05-07

AWS Announces General Availability of Agent Toolkit and MCP Server

AWS launched the Agent Toolkit for AWS, including the generally available AWS MCP Server, providing a managed environment for AI coding agents to build on AWS reliably and securely. The toolkit ships 40+ validated agent skills spanning IaC, storage, analytics, serverless, containers, and AI services, plus three plugins (AWS Core, Data Analytics, Agents). The MCP Server adds IAM-based guardrails, CloudWatch/CloudTrail observability, sandboxed Python execution, and one-tool access to any AWS API. Available at no extra charge in N. Virginia and Frankfurt regions, the toolkit cements AWS as the default substrate for production AI agent workloads.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/05/agent-toolkit/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-05-06

HPE Moves Self-Driving Networks From Vision to Reality with Autonomous AIOps Across Mist and Aruba Central

HPE announced what it calls the industry's first fully autonomous, agentic AIOps networking, expanding self-driving capabilities across HPE Mist AI and Aruba Central. New autonomous actions automatically detect, diagnose, and remediate issues – including RF capacity tuning, dynamic frequency selection, VLAN misconfig fixes, rogue DHCP mitigation, and roaming/security incidents – with optional human guardrails. The UK Ministry of Justice cited a ~75% reduction in service desk tickets while managing 15,000 devices. Built on a microservices/agentic mesh architecture with OpenRoaming and Zero Trust enhancements, the rollout cements HPE Networking's post-Juniper-acquisition strategy against Cisco Meraki.

Source: <https://www.hpe.com/us/en/newsroom/press-release/2026/05/hpe-moves-self-driving-networks-from-vision-to-reality-with-autonomous-networking-capabilities.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-05-06

Fortinet Expands FortiGate G Series with 3500G and 400G to Secure AI Workloads

Fortinet expanded its FortiGate G Series with two new high-performance models – the FortiGate 3500G and 400G – purpose-built to secure AI traffic from the data center to enterprise edge. Powered by Fortinet's NP7 and SP5 ASICs running FortiOS 8.0, the new firewalls deliver native AI visibility controls, hardware-enforced integrity, 400Gb connectivity, and ASIC-accelerated inspection of encrypted, AI-driven, and east-west traffic. Capabilities include MCP and agent-to-agent traffic inspection, integrated FortiGuard AI-Powered Security Services, and a unified zero-trust architecture targeting AI deployments without sacrificing performance.

Source: <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/05/06/3288892/0/en/Fortinet-Expands-FortiGate-G-Series-to-Secure-AI-from-the-Data-Center-to-Modern-Enterprise-Edges.html>

ACQUISITION

Cisco

2026-05-06

Cisco to Acquire Astrix Security to Secure AI Agents and Non-Human Identities

Cisco announced its intent to acquire Israeli cybersecurity firm Astrix Security – a leader in Non-Human Identity (NHI) security – reportedly for around \$300–400M. The deal targets the rapidly expanding 'agentic workforce' risk, where autonomous AI agents act with privileged access at machine speed. Astrix's platform discovers AI agents and MCP servers, manages their lifecycle, detects excessive privileges, and stops real-time threats. Cisco plans to integrate Astrix into its Identity Intelligence platform and zero-trust portfolio (Secure Access, Duo). The acquisition follows Cisco's recent Galileo deal and its RSAC 2026 push around DefenseClaw and Duo Agentic Identity.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/news/cisco-announces-intent-to-acquire-astrix-security>